

politically for forgiveness programs. We can save for retirement while also knowing that starving ourselves of life's little pleasures or working ourselves to exhaustion isn't the only road. We can prepare for future medical debts while still calling our congressional representatives or running for office ourselves to put universal health care in place.

Professor William Darity's findings on wealth inequality are too staggering to be one person's responsibility. "The key thing is, you cannot close these gaps through autonomous, individual action," he said. "These gaps will not be closed by the people who have little income behaving differently, making different decisions. The magnitudes of these gaps have nothing to do with the personal or individual decisions people make about their finances."

And so as I finish up a book telling you what to do about money problems, I have to take my own advice because my finances are still not good. They may never be as good as I want them to be. They'll go through phases of better and then worse and then better and then worse than ever before. Even though I made "money" into my full-time job, something I suspect not everyone has the time or inclination to do, I *still* don't have an infallible handle on my accounts. I still have so much to learn before I reach full financial competence, and even then I can't predict what will happen in my future.

There's racial, classist, ableist, transphobic, homophobic, and misogynist tints to money that can't be ignored. Black and Latinx trans women suffer a wider wage and employment gap than cis white women. People with disabilities on SSI can't save as much as they'd like to. Cancer survivors have medical debt that is considered "cosmetic" and not covered by insurance. There's no good person or bad person when it comes to money. As Clio Chang wrote in her piece about the "empathy gap," being part of a society doesn't mean resources are just for the people we like; it means resources are for everyone, even the people we actively don't like. This alien affects everyone. So while you work to better your own money situation, you also *have* to look at the big picture.

It's really hard to do both when it comes to money, but we can't be like that crew in Antarctica, guys. We can't let it tear us apart.